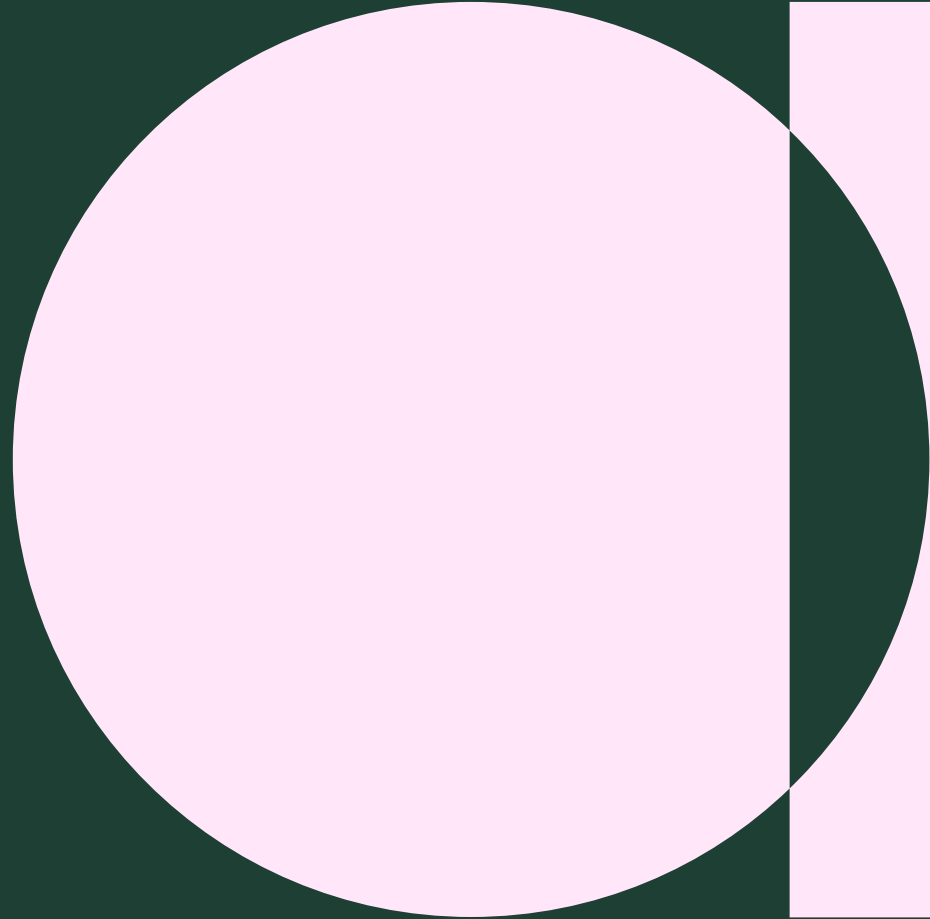
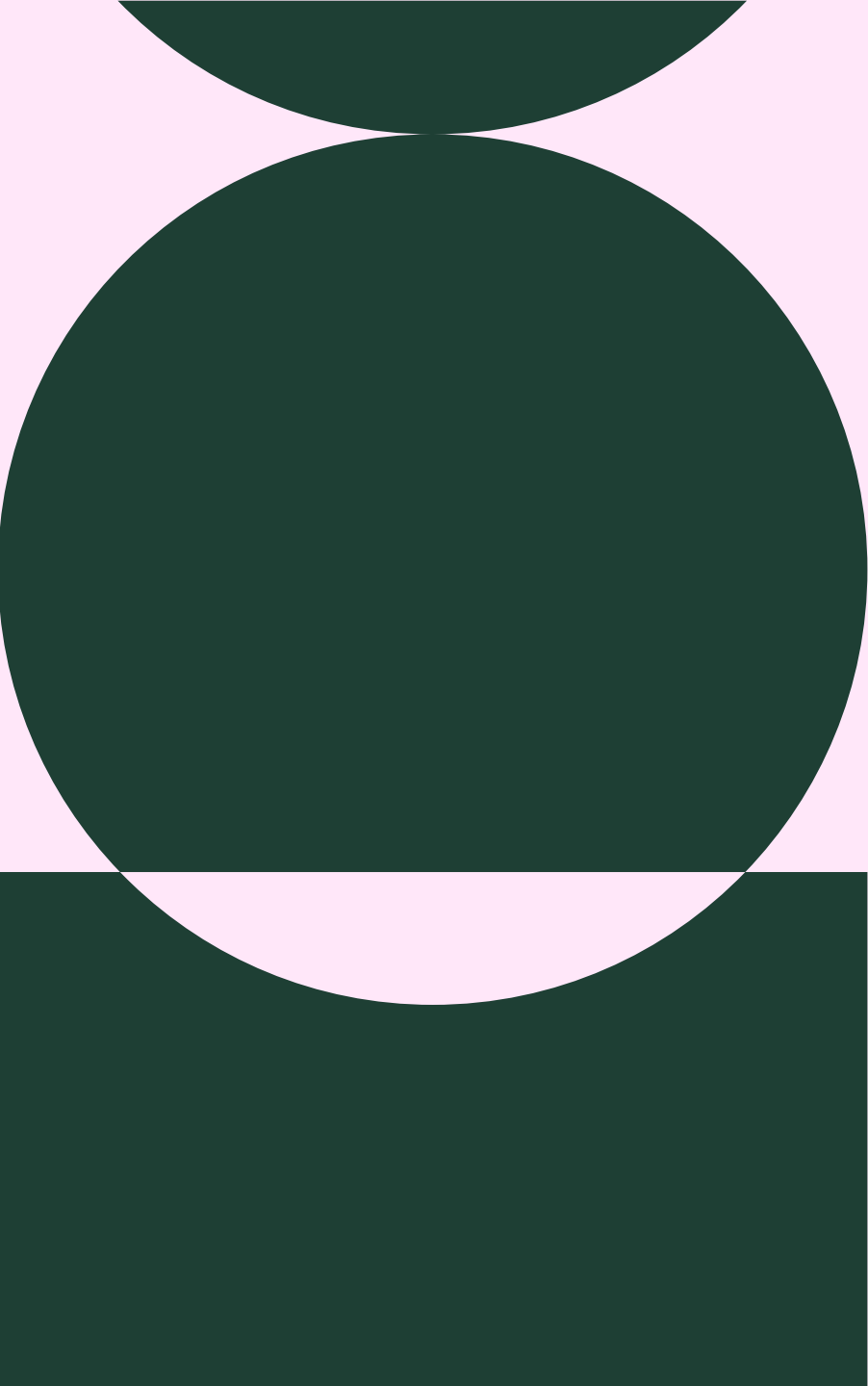


Art, Emotions & AI



Lusha Zhang



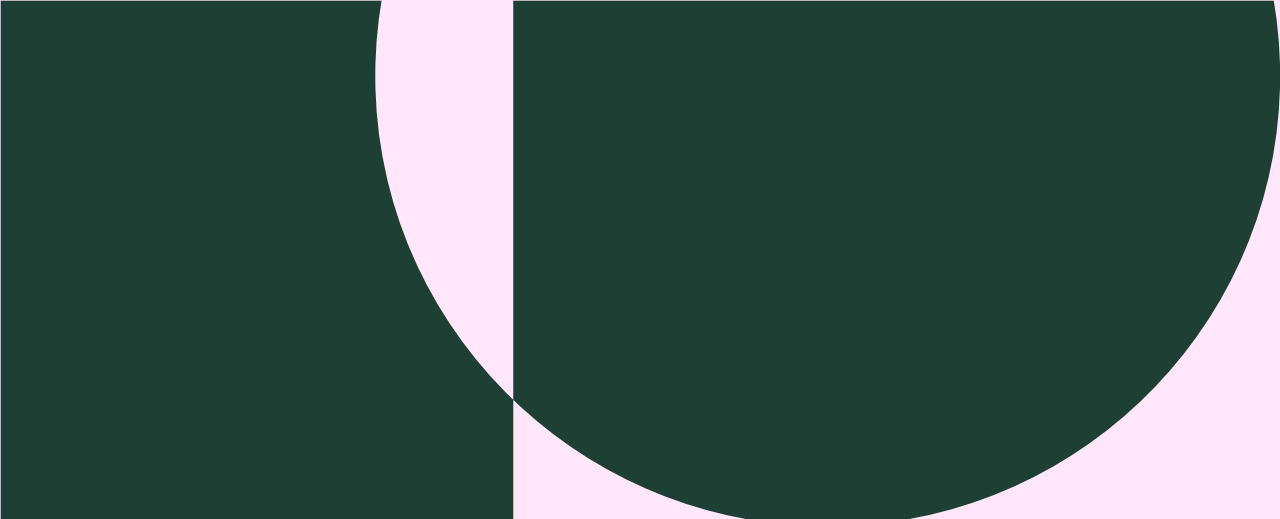
Agenda

- 1. My Study Theme**
- 2. My Learnings**
- 3. Implementation Plan**
- 4. Demo**

01 My Study Theme



Vincent van Gogh
Irises



“ I’m interested in using agentic and generative AI as tools for emotional mediation, helping people understand how art can be used for mood-based psychosocial support.”

02 My Learnings



Pierre BONCOMPAIN
Vase of sunflowers

From Initial Idea to Final Study Theme

My initial study theme:

"I would like to explore Occam's Razor and how it make model selection and life attitude better."



My final study theme:

*"I'm interested in using **agentic and generative AI** as tools for **emotional mediation**, helping people understand how **art** can be used for psychosocial support."*

Paper - *Toward emotional mediation: generative AI in art therapy for psychosocial health support (1)*

Main idea

This paper argues that generative AI should be viewed not only as a creative tool, but as a possible emotional mediator in art therapy and psychosocial support

Key contribution

The authors describe **2 broad trajectories** for AI in art therapy:

- ❑ AI as an expressive co-creator that helps people externalize feelings through image-making
 - ❑ AI as a therapeutic assistant that supports assessment, feedback, and guided reflection
-

5 proposed roles of AI

- Emotional recognizer: detects emotional cues
 - Emotional externalizer: turns feelings into visual forms
 - Emotional regulator: adapts prompts or pacing for support
 - Empathic mirror: encourages reflection and dialogue
 - Space-builder: creates calming, affect-aware environments
-

Paper - *Toward emotional mediation: generative AI in art therapy for psychosocial health support (2)*

Why it matters

AI-enabled art therapy may **expand access**, **reduce creative barriers**, and offer **new channels** for emotional expression, especially for people with limited verbal communication or cognitive challenges.

Cautions

The paper also highlights major risks:

loss of user agency, bias, privacy concerns, emotional surveillance, and over-reliance on AI in sensitive therapeutic settings.

Takeaway

AI should **complement, not replace, human therapists**. Reduce interaction stage and provide more space for users.

03 Implementation Plan



Vincent van Gogh
Oleanders

Implementation plan - Agentic + GenAI for Emotional Mediation

Study focus

Build and evaluate a neural NLP pipeline that 1) reads concise mood reflections, 2) detects emotion in context, 3) reframes the emotion into a supportive art prompt, and 4) retrieves emotionally aligned artworks for mood-based psychosocial support.

What I will build

- Transformer-based emotion classifier
- Emotion-reframing prompt layer
- CLIP*-based artwork retrieval
- Lightweight agent workflow + UI

What technology I will deploy

- Python + Hugging Face transformers
- RoBERTa or BERT classifier
- CLIP text-image embeddings

What I will test

- Classification accuracy + emotional relevance
- Retrieval quality + supportiveness
- Safety, transparency, and user trust

Note: this is a mood-support and reflective recommendation system, not a diagnostic or clinical therapy tool.

**CLIP (Contrastive Language-Image Pretraining trained by OpenAI)*

Neural System Design - From Mood Reflection to Art Recommendation



Data plan

- Input data: short mood reflections or emotion-labeled text
- Artwork data: artwork images plus metadata, captions, tags, or descriptions
- Intermediate data: supportive art prompts generated from the emotional reflections

Deployment plan

- Precompute artwork embeddings for faster retrieval
- Serve the prototype through a small interactive web app

Feedback Evaluation

- Collect feedback on whether results feel supportive
- Use feedback to refine future recommendations

Methodology Research Comparison

Classical approach

- Lexicon-based emotion classification with emotion dictionaries
- Rule-based mapping from emotion label to supportive art tags
- Tag-based retrieval from a manually annotated artwork set

Neural approach

- Transformer-based emotion classification from reflective text
- Emotion reframing into a supportive semantic prompt
- Embedding-based retrieval with CLIP text-image similarity

Pros	simple, interpretable, low compute, easy to control	stronger contextual understanding and richer emotional nuance
Cons	weak context handling and rigid recommendations	higher compute cost, lower interpretability, possible bias

Why I choose the neural approach

Emotional mediation depends on subtle, context-based feelings, a neural pipeline is a better fit than keyword-based methods. The classical approach still serves as a transparent baseline, and the neural approach should be tested with human feedback, transparency, and safety in mind.

04 Demo



Vincent van Gogh
Vase with Daisies and Poppies

***“With
freedom,
books,
flowers,
and the moon,***

***who could not be perfectly
happy?”***

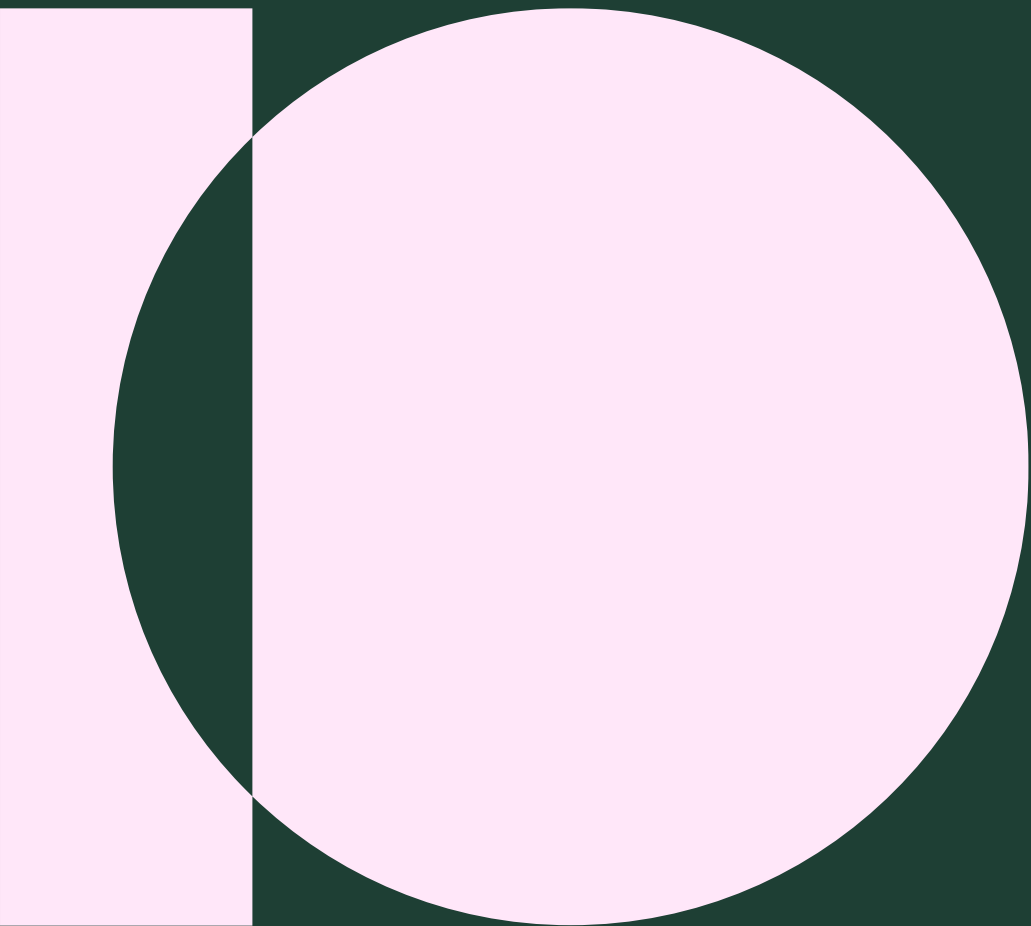
– Oscar Wilde



Pierre BONCOMPAIN
Feminine reverie under the arums

“I’m interested in using agentic
and generative AI as tools
for emotional mediation,

helping people understand how
art can be used for mood-based
psychosocial support.”



Thank You